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Sports Data Soccer API - NLG Match Preview Feed (MA22)

Get a match preview with basic information - plus a detailed overview with recent form, highlights and season statistics for higher tiers.

Overview

NLG stands for Natural Language Generation. It is an automated system that creates textual editorial content from raw data. In the Soccer **NLG Match Preview feed**, we are using specifically curated raw data that is organised and parsed into a format that we can then use as a foundation for repeatable, yet varying, editorial outputs.

- **What is a 'Basic' Match Preview?** As the name suggests, it is the basic match information. It uses lower tiers of data coverage, covering over 150 leagues (domestic leagues collected from Opta Data Tiers 3, 7 and 8).
- **What is a 'Detailed' Preview?** A detailed Match Preview uses high-end data collection available for over 70 leagues (domestic leagues collected from Opta Data Tiers 9, 10, 11 and 13). As the name suggests, it is more developed than the 'Basic' preview, with more extensive Opta data and designed to be more 'readable' - it has sub-sections to allow a reader to find key information quickly and easily.

Required Compliance:

To comply with our API security and best practice logic for your API calls please refer to our **FAQs**. We also recommend that you take a look at our **API Overview and Authentication Guide**. You will learn the basics of how our API works and key concepts to get started.

How Often Should I Poll The Feed?

We have provided some guidelines to help ensure that you call the feed only as often as you need to. Make sure that you don't exceed the rate confirmed with us - this can vary depending on whether you make requests as a B2B or B2C outlet - if you need more information on this, contact your Stats Perform representative.

UPDATES AND POLLING FREQUENCY

Previews should be available up to 72 hours before a game, with a minimum expectation of 48 hours for an individual match. If the team's previous game has happened less than 48 hours before the next game, the Preview will arrive at the earliest practical opportunity.

NLG Match Preview (MA22) Guide

USAGE**FEED**GET a **match preview** by fixture UUID (path parameter method) in XML or JSON.

/soccerdata/nlgmatchpreview/{outletAuthKey}

If your request URL is as follows - that is, it does not contain a fixture UUID AND `_lc1` parameter and value - the feed returns an error: /soccerdata/nlgmatchpreview/{outletAuthKey}

Query Parameters And Example Request Parameters

This feed also makes use of the **Global query parameters**, and you can combine them with the following query parameters (some of which can be used in conjunction with each other). However, you must query the `/nlgmatchpreview` feed by a specific fixture (match) UUID and include the `_lc1` parameter and a **valid locale value**.

Legacy IDs: You can use the `fx` parameter to filter by legacy IDs - only one ID is supported (you cannot pass multiple IDs in a comma-separated list).

How to use query parameters and make successful requests:

In our guides, we use HTTPS syntax for our example GET requests (rather than cURL, for example). All URLs are case-sensitive - this means that URL strings must contain the correct case and operators. You MUST format your requests correctly and include certain information; otherwise, an error will be returned. You can find information about the API, including the base URL (`{protocol}://{requestDomain}/{feedResource}`), in the **main guide** and **API Overview and Authorisation guide**.

- Include the following information in the URL or header and make sure it is correct for your outlet: your unique and valid `{outletAuthKey}` this must be after the Outlet Authentication Key (and endpoint, if applicable). for `_rt={mode}` (operating mode) and `_fmt={dataFormat}` (response format), entity query parameter and UUID.
- Begin the query parameter string with `?` (question mark) - this must be after the Outlet Authentication Key (and endpoint, if applicable). To build up a query string, make sure that each query parameter is separated by the `&` (ampersand) operator. Values must be separated by the correct operator, for example `&` (multiple values, 'AND'), or - if a parameter supports it - `,` (multiple values, 'OR') or `!` ('NOT').
- Use the required `_` (underscore) for any parameters listed with this prefix.
- Remove any placeholder value curly braces `{ }` from your calls (we include these as an example only).
- If using the JSONP format (`_fmt=jsonp`) you MUST use it in combination with the callback parameter (`_clbk`) and a fixed value (or where you use a different value in a different instance, you must do this as little as possible). Be aware that common JavaScript frameworks, such as jQuery, can default to use randomly-generated function names - you must make sure that these are overridden and define a fixed function name instead.

Query parameter	Value and description
<code>{fixtureUuid}</code>	GET Match Preview NLG data by the specified fixture UUID (path parameter method). Pass the fixture UUID in the request URL directly as the <code>{assetId}</code> (asset/resource ID). <pre>GET http://api.performfeeds.com/soccerdata/nlgmatchpreview/{outletAuthKey}/{fixtureUuid}?_rt={mode}&_fmt={dataFormat}</pre>

Query parameter	Value and description
<code>fx + _lcl</code> (Opta 'legacy' ID only)	GET Match Preview NLG data by the specified Opta legacy 'fx' ID (query parameter method). Pass the match ID to the <code>fx</code> parameter, and the locale value (for example, <code>_lcl=en-gb</code>) to the <code>_lcl</code> parameter (mandatory). <pre>GET http://api.performfeeds.com/soccerdata/nlgmatchpreview/{outletAuthKey}?_rt={mode}&_fmt={dataFormat}&fx=urn:perform:opta:fixture:{fixtureUuid}&_lcl={value}</pre>
<code>_lcl</code>	Specify the language/locale value to the _lcl parameter to return the feed in a particular language. If you do not specify the parameter, the feed language defaults to English. <pre>GET https://api.performfeeds.com/soccerdata/nlgmatchpreview/{outletAuthKey}?_rt={mode}&_fmt={dataFormat}&fx={fixtureUuid}&lcl={value}</pre> Note: If translations for the requested language are unavailable, the feed response will fall back to the default language, English.

Sample Calls

These sample calls let you see an example URL and the response - click on the links below (hyperlinks open in a new window).

- [XML](#)
- [JSON](#)

Example Responses - Basic Preview And Detailed Preview

Click on the links below to see complete examples of responses from the feed for a match with a Basic Preview and a match with a Detailed Preview.

These example calls and responses are for different matches. This is because a match will only ever have one preview available, either a Basic Preview or a Detailed Preview, depending on its coverage level (a match will never have both available).

► [Basic Preview example \(XML\) - Caernarfon Twon vs The New Saints](#)

► [Detailed Preview example \(XML\) - Norwich City vs Liverpool](#)

Feed Output

Here, you can find an explanation of all possible response fields and data. This is XML but fields in the feed response are similar for JSON.

► `<nlgMatchPreview>` (XML only)

► `<matchInfo>`

► `<description>`

► `<sport>`

▶<ruleset>

▶<competition>

▶<country>

▶<tournamentCalendar>

▶<stage>

▶<series>

▶<contestants> (XML only)

▶<contestant>

▶<country>

▶<venue>

▶<playerIds>

▶<messages>

▶<message>

▶<highlights>

▶<formGuide>

▶<headToHead>

▶<lastHeadToHead>

▶<topScorers>

▶<didYouKnow>

▶<upNext>

▶<home>

▶<away>